

The need to explore space

It is a question born out of common sense as much as anything else: “Why should we spend billions of dollars, enormous human energy and the efforts of some of mankind’s leading minds on something like exploring space when there are already so many problems here on Earth?”

There are several answers offered by some of the world’s greatest thinkers, but more often than not, it all boils down to one thing: discovery. The exploration of the unknown – be it scientific or in terms of travel – is not just about quenching our innate curiosity, it’s the only way we can come across new things. And something truly new, more often than not, leads to great and positive changes.

Imagine a world where Christopher Columbus was denied the opportunity to sail westwards on his notion that Earth is round and eventually land in India. He would never have discovered the Americas and who knows how the world would look today.

Discovery has no practical purpose – those are by-products of it. There are already enough examples of space technology being adapted to solve problems on Earth, from shock-absorbing helmets to space shuttle fuel pump technology that’s being adapted into a device that helps heal a child’s heart.

Of course, this isn’t a good enough explanation for many and while we wouldn’t claim to be able to convince you, it would be worthwhile to spend some time thinking about these famous quotes from some of the visionaries and thinkers of our time, helpfully compiled in a longer list at

www.spacequotes.com.